



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Operations

PRINCIPLES OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP SERIES

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- “The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation.”
- “You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge).”
- “You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event.”
- “Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event.”

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of operations.
2. Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs.
3. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
4. Explain the nature of positive customer relations.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the owner of SNACK ATTACK!, a small snack box delivery business that you started at your school. You create and deliver custom snack boxes that include a mix of chips, cookies, candy, and drinks. Students place orders online through your simple website, and you deliver the snack boxes to their classrooms during lunch or after school.

Your teacher (judge) is your business advisor who helps you figure out ways to improve how your business runs. Lately, you've been having some operational problems that are costing you time and money. These include:

- Students changing their orders last-minute, which means you end up with extra snacks you can't always sell.
- Some snack items get damaged during delivery because they are packed too loosely or the drink spills.
- You sometimes run out of popular items (like certain chips or candy) because you didn't order enough in advance.

You want to grow your business, but these problems are making things harder. Your business advisor (judge) has asked you to come up with new operations strategies that can help you run your business more smoothly and avoid waste.

Your task is to:

- Create a plan to handle inventory better so you don't run out of your best-selling items.
- Suggest a better way to pack and deliver the snack boxes so they stay in good condition.
- Come up with a policy for order changes or cancellations, so you don't lose money.

You will present your ideas to your business advisor (judge) in a role-play to take place in your advisor's (judge's) classroom. The business advisor (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the advisor's (judge's) questions, the advisor (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. If a student wants to cancel or change their order on the same day, how will your new policy handle that?
2. How will you keep track of which snack items are most popular so you can make better inventory decisions?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of operations.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Demonstrate a customer service mindset.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Explain the nature of positive customer relations.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
5.	Unique Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	Practical Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Effective Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
8.	Critical Thinking Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	Communication Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Decision Making Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
11.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
TOTAL SCORE						